

attempt to find affordable spaces that can store high-speed computer servers and cooling systems that diffuse heat generated by the servers. It is estimated that 78 per cent of cryptocurrency mining facilities are consuming electricity derived from renewable resources.

Bitcoin ATMs

Bitcoin ATM (abbreviated as BATM) kiosks are machines, which allow the insertion of cash or a credit card in exchange for Bitcoin. These look like traditional ATMs but are not connected with a bank account. Bitcoin ATMs connect customers directly to a Bitcoin exchange for a localised and convenient way to purchase Bitcoin in person.

BATM allows a person to buy Bitcoin using an automatic teller machine. Some Bitcoin ATMs offer bi-directional functionality, enabling both the purchase as well as the sale of Bitcoins for cash. Bitcoin machines are not exactly the same as traditional ATMs, but these work in a similar way.

There are reportedly over 3800 cryptocurrency ATMs operating in 76

countries. In India, the first such ATM was installed at Kemp Fort Mall, Bengaluru, on October 14, 2018.

Once a customer visits the ATM, he validates his user ID and then enters a one-time password (OTP) sent to his registered mobile number. He can then deposit money, and the updated balance will be displayed. To purchase cryptocurrencies, the user will have to use a mobile application. The process for withdrawals is similar.

Concerns about cryptocurrency

Since the inception of Bitcoin, only one critical vulnerability has been found in its implementation, when one malefactor snagged 92 billion Bitcoins. Fixing that required rolling back the entire financial record by 24 hours. Nevertheless, just one vulnerability in over ten years is praiseworthy.

Due to the anonymous nature of operations, cryptocurrencies were used by unsocial elements for money laundering and trade in prohibited items. If your Bitcoin wallet is lost, all Bitcoins get lost. These cannot be regained until and unless backed up

with a backup phrase code.

Bitcoin prices are quite volatile. Speculators wish to take advantage of it, but genuine investors consider it risky and therefore hesitate to invest in Bitcoins and other cryptocurrencies.

Conclusion

This article aims to create an understanding of cryptocurrency amongst the common man. Cryptocurrency is realisation of innovator's dream of digital currency to achieve a unique combination of three features—anonymity, independence from a central authority, and double-spending attack protection. The legal status of cryptocurrencies varies from country to country.

Any new technology faces resistance due to unawareness about its functionality. Research scholars in places like MIT have created improved versions of the first innovation, Bitcoin. Internet entrepreneur, Mark Zuckerberg has announced the launch of its cryptocurrency Libra on which the R&D team at Facebook is assiduously working. **EFY**



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